

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1235

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor Senior Deputy Attorney General Scott Sutherland on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to an attorney for the State of Tennessee who has devoted his career to public service; and

WHEREAS, Senior Deputy Attorney General Scott Sutherland earned a Bachelor of Arts degree from Georgetown College and a Juris Doctor degree from the University of Kentucky College of Law; and

WHEREAS, he first distinguished himself in public service to the Commonwealth of Kentucky, pursuing justice without fear or favor as an Assistant Attorney General; in 2011, he joined the Office of the Tennessee Attorney General and Reporter as a member of the Criminal Appeals Division; and

WHEREAS, he has subsequently served as Deputy Attorney General of the Law Enforcement and Special Prosecutions Division and Senior Deputy Attorney General of the Civil Law Section; and

WHEREAS, throughout his fifteen years of service to the State of Tennessee, General Sutherland has distinguished himself as an exceptional lawyer and leader; and

WHEREAS, he has diligently selected and developed outstanding attorneys, many of whom still serve the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland has set a profound standard of kindness and respectfulness in his interactions with his colleagues, subordinates, and those against whom he has litigated, regardless of their power, importance, or political party; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland has tirelessly placed the interests of the State of Tennessee above his own, regularly sacrificing personal and family time when his duties exceeded regular working hours; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland has protected the interests of justice and the rights of victims by defending the convictions and sentences of many of Tennessee's most violent criminals; and

WHEREAS, he has scrupulously safeguarded public trust in government by investigating public corruption and misconduct; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland has protected the will of Tennesseans by defending the laws passed by their elected representatives, and he has earned the respect of the federal and State jurists before whom he practiced and the many lawyers in Tennessee against whom he litigated; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland is renowned for his judgment among his peers; his excellence as a lawyer and his value as a public servant have been duly recognized, as he was honored with the Attorney General and Reporter's 2023 William M. Leech Jr. Award; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee and its many agencies and officials have benefited invaluablely from General Sutherland's representation and his unhesitating commitment to truth and justice; and

WHEREAS, General Sutherland is retiring from his duties at the end of the fiscal year; we acknowledge that although his office may be filled, he can never truly be replaced; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Senior Deputy Attorney General Scott Sutherland on the occasion of his retirement from service, salute his fifteen years spent

safeguarding the interests of the State of Tennessee, and extend to him our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.